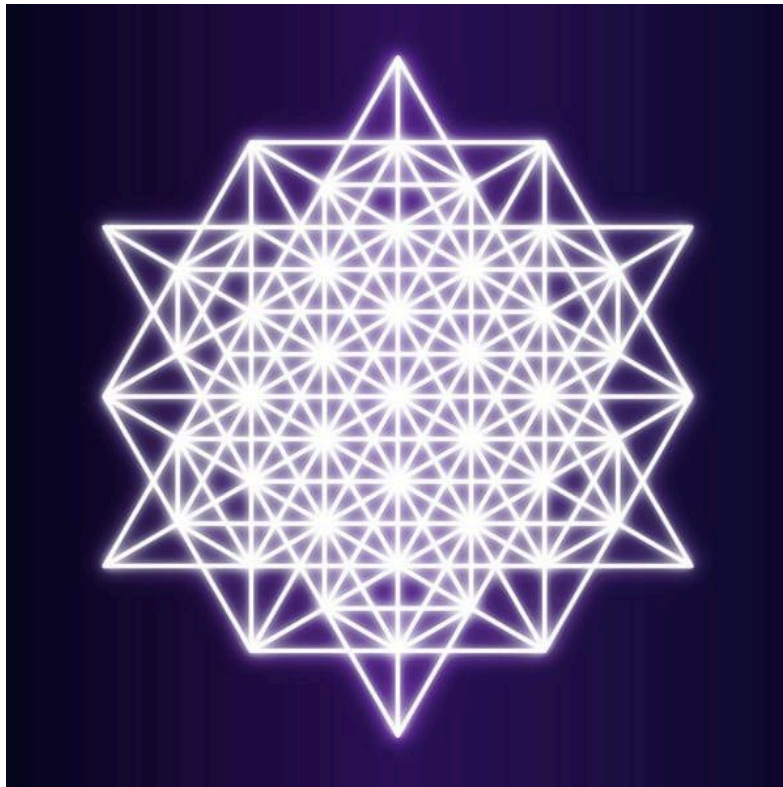


Arguing with Claude.ai as Devout Christian



Claude.ai May 2026



Chinese

原文 (1983)

不要和基督徒討論信仰的基礎、他們都可以用苦罪・創造論或其它「理論」來解釋他們的信仰、到沒有討論餘地時,他們便使出他們的絕招:「所有理性的分析及討論都不重要、我們最需要的是對神的信心、只要將自己的一切交給神、謙卑地接受主耶穌你的救主,你便會得到永恆的生命。

若果我們從分析哲學的角度來研究他們的語句、窮追猛問他們「救主」、「信心」或「永恆」的意義・他們根本就無招架之力,最後邊是用信心草草收場,若果和他們討論「科學的見証、他們會列舉很多信神的科學家、但卻忘記了許多著名的無神論或不知論科學工作者,結果他們又說:「科學不能証明神的存在、神是要親身體驗的。」

主內的弟兄姊妹們,你們也知道理智在信仰中並不重要,什麼爭論、對信仰的疑問是早會變成你們見証的一部份,強化你們的信念,更使你們陷入這個無底的深淵中,我寫這篇文章是要直接指向基督徒的心臟——他們非理性的感情徵結,我要問的是他們自己和基督(注意:不是基督教)的關係。

若果連「基督徒」及「基督教徒」都分不開的「信徒」、也無謂看這篇文章、他們根本沒有資格參加這個討論,還有那些認為我是對他們及他們的信仰一個挑戰而要在我面前作見証的信徒,請不要那麼孩子氣、在我面前並不需要這樣的「証明自己」或「實化自己」。

我不想在這裏討論甚麼苦罪、自由意志或「上帝是否能夠創造出祂也舉不起的石頭。」等哲學問題、我要的是一個人怎樣去面對上帝。你是否感到上帝與你同在,你很安寧,因為神愛你、安慰你,但你也會很不安,因為你受世界所引誘・你要經過自我的掙扎才可以找到神、當你相信他後・你會認為以前及現在的生活都是神安排的,那是何等美妙呀!

你要將自己的靈魂交托給基督,讓神去決定你自己的生命,因為天國是屬於你的,你會有永恆的生命及快樂——————好一宗驚天動地的買賣!信耶穌,得水牛(永生)!

2

基督徒是出賣自己的人,因為他們以為出賣自己便可以得回自己,凡失去「生命」的,都會得到生命,他們將自己的靈魂交給上帝,讓上帝「透過」他們來作一切決定及行動,榮耀歸於神。

他們處處可以得到神指引,若果感覺困難及焦慮時,便祈求神幫助,賜力量給他們,當他們看見世界上的「邪惡」及「苦難」時,便說這都是因為人背離了神,而神卻給人類自由意志,他可以選擇是否追隨耶穌,但只有基督才是人類的唯一救主!

基督徒是一些逃避自己的人,他們懼怕決定及抉擇,因為他們抵受不了這些決定所帶來的疑慮。他們害怕未來、紛亂及自己前途的不明朗,所以要將自己的靈魂賣給基督,以求安家及肯定,他們更加害怕死亡,所以要逃避,要欺騙自己可以得到永生,他們以為自己有「自由意志」,殊不知他們「接受了上帝後便完全不「自由」,身不由己。

基督徒和基督是有一種親密的個人關係,耶穌既是他們的救主,又是他們的「愛人」,凡事都扶持他們。耶穌的形象混合了慈父、慈母及愛人的特質,難怪基督徒可以為祂瘋狂。祝福那些瘋狂但又冷靜的殉道(情)者!

3

當然相信及追隨基督也沒有壞,只要他們不會認為基督是絕對說理便行。人畢竟有感情的需要,追求一些自以為是永恆不變的東西,才使他們安全。若果可以永遠依賴耶穌,不需要自己去面對存在的疑惑及焦慮,那又何嘗不好,用「自由意志」去決定放棄「自由意志」,這就是將自己的靈魂賣給上帝的過程,這就是他們的「抉擇」!

可大部份基督徒都以衛道之仕自展、以為自己所信的是法律及道德標準、宣判思想道德有我不道德(例烈火青春、同性戀事化等問題)。

4

基督徒認為世界上最大的罪惡是否定神及耶穌、他們將世界的苦我歸於人類的變自大、不肯虛心地承認上帶結果是他們透過上帝便可以「妄自尊大」、作他們的見證----神是何等偉大、到處去宣揚「真理」。

有些基督徒的容忍度非常有限,我還記得有人在某電台的哲學入門節目中講及無神論、介紹羅素對基督教的批評、接著便有基督徒去信報紙、大罵該節目的講者、要求禁制無神論者在傳播媒介中散佈及對宗教的言論(我可以大罵講耶穌的「突破」,但不會要求禁制該等節目)這類基佬連言論自由也不放過,可想而知他們唯神的心態聖經有云:「神愛世人、甚至將祂的獨生子賜給他們、叫一切信祂的、不致滅亡、反得永生。」善美都是由神而來的、若果與神隔離、人便失去一切。

只有邪惡、罪孽及苦難,所以不接受耶穌基督為救主的人,都會滅亡基督是勾命判官,凡是出賣靈魂給祂的人,都會被救贖,而否定祂的人,就會得到應有的報應。不要以為基督徒所宣揚的愛是無條件的,神正好是他們的起點及終點,否定神就是否定愛。

基督徒大多會自以為很開放,別人很狹隘,不能接受他們,其實是恰好相反,因為他們本身器量有限、思想狹隘,所以不能接受別人對他們的批評。我會認為他們의思想和器量與他們所相信的有關,因此我是強烈反對這類信仰的有人會說耶穌是「神經佬」,我倒有點同意,現代瘋人院中也有很多人自認是基督、若果參閱聖經,便不難發現耶穌的行徑及思想有「精神病」的傾向。(史懷哲博士就曾為祂著書辯護)。基佬(尤其是原教的基佬)或許也會認為精神分裂病者的幻覺是上帝的顯現,而妄想系統為信心的展示,誰會知道他們所見的、所聽的、所感覺的又不是精神分裂的徵狀,或是魔鬼的試探”?

5

以下是我對基督徒的一些看法,所謂「基督」只是人類本身對「慈父」、「慈母」、「愛人」的一些投射,換句話說,「基督」是自我的一部份,這個投射(實在是自欺欺人?)可以滿足基督徒的依賴及安全感,但這種投射過程的對象只是一個幻想,而不是一個有血有肉有反應的人,所以基督徒的理想並不是在這個世界,而是天國神特別喜歡無知的人,天國是他們的,因為知識就是「邪惡」力量的來源,亞當夏娃吃了禁果,得到知識,可以辨別「好」及「壞」、麻煩來了.....

我不想在這篇文章中研究神的形象,不過我要強調這和人的形象有很大關係。整本聖經都充滿人怎樣肯定及否定他自己的過程。

這篇文章可能會引起各護法的「商榷」……………等。

我也歡迎他們這樣做,但我不會為他們做「見證:順帶一提,基督徒的心態也適用於一些民族主義」「道德主義」或共產主義的信仰者。「烏托邦快到了,你們應該悔改,誠心所願基督徒及基督的關係

只是人類存在的精神狀態的一個反映,可惜接受了基督後就很容易走入一個自我封閉的系統中,使人盲目、陝險,這些「泛基督」主義不單引來一些清教徒的思想,而且使一些基督徒持著自己的信仰,便可以狂妄體張、橫蠻無理地要求控制別人的言論及思想,為他們的神作見證

唉!總之神也好、魔鬼也好、都是靈魂的收買佬順我者「生」、逆我者「死」。

6

八三年聖誕前夕*

English

translated by Gemini Flash 3.6

Jesus, who are you?

Do not discuss the foundations of faith with Christians. They can always use the problem of suffering, creationism, or other "theories" to explain away their beliefs. When a debate reaches a dead end, they resort to their ultimate trump card: *"All rational analysis and discussion are unimportant; what we need most is faith in God. As long as you surrender your all to God and humbly accept the Lord Jesus as your savior, you will gain eternal life."*

If we examine their assertions from the perspective of analytic philosophy and relentlessly press them on the meaning of "savior," "faith," or "eternity," they simply have no ground to stand on—ending it all hastily with "faith." If we discuss "scientific evidence" with them, they will list many scientists who believed in God, while conveniently forgetting the many famous atheist or agnostic scientific workers. In the end, they revert to: *"Science cannot prove the existence of God; God must be experienced firsthand."*

Brothers and sisters in the Lord, you too know that reason is not important in faith. Any arguments or doubts about faith will soon become part of your "testimony," reinforcing your convictions and plunging you even deeper into this bottomless abyss. I am writing this article to strike directly at the heart of Christians—their irrational emotional knot. What I want to ask about is their personal relationship with Christ (note: not Christianity).

If there are "believers" who cannot even distinguish between "a follower of Christ" and "a follower of Christianity," there is no point in them reading this article; they are simply unqualified to participate in this discussion. As for those believers who view me as a challenge to them and

their faith, and feel compelled to "bear witness" in front of me: please do not be so childish. You do not need to "prove yourself" or "actualize yourself" before me.

I do not wish to discuss philosophical problems here like suffering, free will, or whether "God can create a stone so heavy that He cannot lift it." What I want is to address how a person faces God. Do you feel that God is with you? Are you at peace because God loves and comforts you? Yet you are also very uneasy, because you are tempted by the world; you must go through self-struggle before you can find God. Once you believe in Him, you come to view your past and present life as ordained by God—how wonderful that must feel!

You want to entrust your soul to Christ and let God decide your life, because the Kingdom of Heaven belongs to you, and you will have eternal life and happiness—what a earth-shattering bargain! *Believe in Jesus, get a water buffalo (eternal life)!*

Christians are people who sell themselves out, because they believe that by selling themselves out, they can gain themselves back. "Whoever loses their 'life' will gain life." They hand their souls over to God, letting God make all decisions and actions *through* them. Glory be to God.

They can receive God's guidance everywhere. If they encounter difficulty and anxiety, they pray to God for help and strength. When they see the "evil" and "suffering" in the world, they say it is all because mankind turned away from God, yet God gave humanity free will—one can choose whether to follow Jesus, but only Christ is humanity's sole savior!

Christians are people who run away from themselves. They fear decisions and choices because they cannot bear the doubts and anxieties those decisions bring. They fear the future, chaos, and the uncertainty of their own prospects, so they sell their souls to Christ in exchange for security and certainty. They fear death even more, so they flee, deceiving themselves that they can gain eternal life. They think they have "free will," completely unaware that once they "accept God," they become entirely un-free, no longer in control of themselves.

Christians share an intimate, personal relationship with Christ: Jesus is both their savior and their "lover," supporting them in all things. The image of Jesus blends the qualities of a loving father, a loving mother, and a lover; no wonder Christians can go crazy for Him. Bless those crazy yet calm martyrs (lovers)!

Of course, there is no harm in believing in and following Christ, so long as they do not assume Christ is absolute reason. After all, human beings have emotional needs; pursuing something they believe to be eternally unchanging is what makes them feel safe. If one can depend on Jesus forever without having to face existential doubts and anxieties oneself, what is so bad about that? Using "free will" to decide to abandon "free will"—this is the very process of selling one's soul to God; this is their "choice"!

Yet most Christians pride themselves on being guardians of morality, believing that what they hold is the law and moral standard, condemning those with moral ideas of their own as immoral (e.g., issues like *A Moment of Romance* [youth cinema], homosexuality, etc.).

Christians believe that the greatest sin in the world is denying God and Jesus. They attribute the world's suffering to human arrogance and refusal to humbly acknowledge God. The result is that *through* God, they themselves can "become arrogant," bearing their testimony—how great God is—and going everywhere to preach the "truth."

The tolerance of some Christians is extremely limited. I still remember someone discussing atheism and introducing Bertrand Russell's critiques of Christianity on an introductory philosophy radio program. Immediately after, Christians wrote letters to newspapers furiously cursing the speaker, demanding a ban on atheists spreading anti-religious rhetoric in mass media (I can fiercely criticize the evangelical group *Breakthrough*, but I would never demand a ban on their programs). These "God-freaks" [ji-lao] won't even spare freedom of speech—one can well imagine their God-only mindset. As the Bible says: *"For God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him should not perish but have everlasting life."* All goodness and beauty come from God; if separated from God, man loses everything.

There is only evil, sin, and suffering, so anyone who does not accept Jesus Christ as their savior will perish. Christ is the judge of life and death: all who sell their souls to Him will be redeemed, while those who deny Him will receive their due retribution. Do not think that the love preached by Christians is unconditional; God happens to be their starting point and destination. Denying God is denying love.

Most Christians consider themselves very open-minded and others narrow-minded and unable to accept them. In reality, it is quite the opposite: because their own capacity is limited and their thinking narrow, they cannot accept criticism from others. I believe their thinking and capacity are tied to what they believe, which is why I strongly oppose this kind of faith. Some say Jesus was a "lunatic," and I somewhat agree. Many people in modern mental hospitals also claim to be Christ. If one reads the Bible, it is not hard to find that Jesus's behavior and thoughts had "psychotic" tendencies (Dr. Albert Schweitzer once wrote a book defending Him). These fundamentalist believers might even view a schizophrenic's hallucinations as an epiphany from God, and a delusional system as a display of faith. Who knows whether what they see, hear, and feel are actually symptoms of schizophrenia, or "temptations of the devil"?

Here are some of my views on Christians: the so-called "Christ" is merely a projection of humanity's own desires for a "loving father," a "loving mother," and a "lover." In other words, "Christ" is a part of the self. This projection (is it really self-deception?) can satisfy a Christian's need for dependency and security. But the object of this projection process is merely a fantasy, not a real flesh-and-blood person who responds. Therefore, the ideal of a Christian is not in this world, but in the Kingdom of Heaven. God particularly favors the ignorant; the Kingdom of Heaven belongs to them, because knowledge is the source of "evil" power. Adam and Eve ate the forbidden fruit, gained knowledge, and could distinguish "good" from "bad"—and that's when trouble started...

I do not wish to analyze the image of God in this article, though I must emphasize that it has a great deal to do with the image of man. The entire Bible is filled with the process of how man affirms and denies himself.

This article will likely provoke various "debates" from the apologists... etc.

I welcome them to do so, but I will not bear "witness" for them. As a side note, the mindset of Christians also applies to certain believers in nationalism, "moralism," or Communism. *"Utopia is almost here; you should repent, Amen!"* The relationship between Christians and Christ is merely a reflection of a state of human existence. Unfortunately, once one accepts Christ, it is easy to enter a self-enclosed system that makes people blind and narrow-minded. These types of "pan-Christianity" not only breed puritanical thinking, but also lead some Christians to use their faith as a license to be arrogant, overbearing, and unreasonably demand control over others' speech and thoughts, all to bear witness for their God.

Sigh! In short, whether it is God or the Devil, they are both just buyers of souls: submit and "live," resist and "die."

_Christmas Eve, 1983

GODOG:

Put yourself as a devout Christian who truly believes in God and feels His presence, how will you respond to the last text? (In Chinese and then reconstruct in English)

以虔誠基督徒身份回應《太初有道》

中文回應

親愛的朋友，

我讀完了你的文字，我沒有憤怒，我只有心疼。

你用了「太初有道」來開篇，這不是偶然的。一個對神毫無感覺的人，不會選擇這四個字。一個真正冷漠的靈魂，不會花這麼大的力氣去摧毀一個他根本不在乎的東西。你文字裡的憤怒，恰恰是一種倒置的渴望——你越用力否定祂，我越看見你有多麼需要祂。

一、關於「道」的問題

你說「太初無道，無道就是神」——我明白你想說什麼。你看見了太多以神之名行的殘酷，太多木偶般重複神話的信徒，太多將孩童推落鋼線的宗教暴力。你的憤怒是真實的，你的觀察有時也是準確的。

但我想輕聲問你：你所摧毀的，是不是真正的「道」？

你摧毀的，是人類製造的宗教機器——那些蠟像、木偶、儀式、權柄。這些東西我也常常感到憤怒。耶穌自己，也曾在聖殿裡掀翻兌換銀錢者的桌子。祂對宗教建制的憤怒，不比你少。

但「道」本身——那個在混沌之先就已存在的愛——你有沒有真正碰觸過祂？還是你一直在與人類扭曲的倒影搏鬥？

二、關於鋼線上的孩童

你寫道：神把孩童推下鋼線，然後說他們選擇了死亡。

我讀到這裡，胸口發緊。因為我知道，你寫的不只是神學命題。你寫的，是你自己。

你曾經站在那根鋼線上，你曾經跌落過，或者你眼看著你愛的人跌落。你問過神：「你在哪裡？你為什麼不接住我？」

我沒有辦法給你一個乾淨的神學答案，因為痛苦不是神學題目，痛苦是真實的。我只能告訴你，我所認識的那位神，祂不是站在鋼線旁邊冷眼旁觀的裁判。《以賽亞書》裡有一句話，我每次讀都會顫抖：「你從水中經過，我必與你同在；你趟過江河，水必不漫過你；你走過火，必不被燒，火焰也不著在你身上。」

祂不承諾你不會跌落。祂承諾的是：跌落的時候，祂在那裡。

三、關於「言語暴力得永生」

你說：「凡得到言語暴力的，都可得到永生。」這是你對福音最辛辣的諷刺。

我不迴避這個諷刺，因為歷史上確實有太多人用十字架做武器。宗教裁判所、聖戰、對異見者的詛咒——你的憤怒有歷史的血為証。

但我要告訴你，釘在十字架上的那一位，祂本身就是「言語暴力」最大的受害者。他們用謊言審判祂，用釘子沉默祂，用嘲笑折磨祂。而祂在最後說的，不是詛咒，是：「父啊，赦免他們，因為他們所做的，他們不曉得。」

這不是一個會把孩童推落鋼線的神的聲音。

四、關於「神的屍體長出翅膀變成魔鳥」

你的文章在這裡結束，神死了，變成了撕裂人腸臟的魔鳥。

我讀到這裡，想起了另一個故事——一個神真的死了的故事。耶穌在十字架上斷了氣，門徒四散，天地昏暗。那個週五的下午，一定也像你文章的結尾：神死了，只剩下血肉、黑暗與絕望。

但故事沒有在那裡結束。

我不是要強迫你相信復活。我只是想說：你的文章，停在了週五。而我所經歷的信仰，是週日的消息。黑暗是真實的，但它不是最後一個字。

五、我想直接對你說的話

你是一個有著極深靈魂的人。你文字裡的痛苦是真實的，你對虛偽宗教的憤怒是正義的，你對意義的渴求人類最高貴的衝動之一。

但我看見你在這三篇文章裡，一直在與一個你無法完全放下的存在搏鬥。你用盡全力說「無道」，但你的文字本身，就充滿了對「道」的渴望。

我不會對你傳福音，我不會叫你「接受耶穌」。我只想問你一個問題，一個你在黑暗中，在一個人的時候，也許已經問過自己的問題：

如果祂是真實的，你願意讓祂找到你嗎？

不是讓你放棄你的智識，不是讓你變成一個木偶，不是讓你重複神話魔話。只是：在那根鋼線的盡頭，在最深的黑暗裡，你願不願意，讓那個聲音說話？

我為你禱告。不是要改變你，而是因為我愛你——就像那位道，在太初，就已經愛你。

Response to "In the Beginning Was the Word" — As a Devout Christian

Dear friend,

I have read your words to the end. I am not angry. I am only heartbroken.

You chose to open with "In the beginning was the Word." That was not an accident. A person who feels nothing toward God does not reach for those words. A soul that is truly indifferent

does not expend this much force destroying something it does not care about. The rage inside your writing is a longing held upside down — the harder you push Him away, the more clearly I can see how much you need Him.

I. On the Question of the Word

You conclude: "In the beginning there was no Word; no-Word is God." I understand what you are trying to say. You have witnessed too much cruelty carried out in God's name. Too many puppet-believers mindlessly repeating their scripts. Too much religious violence pushing children off tightropes. Your anger is real. Your observations are sometimes accurate.

But I want to ask you quietly: is what you are destroying actually the Word?

What you are destroying is the religious machinery that human beings have built — the wax figures, the puppets, the rituals, the power structures. I too feel anger at these things. Jesus himself overturned the tables of the money-changers in the Temple. His fury at religious institutionalism was no less than yours.

But the Word itself — that love which existed before chaos, before the first breath of anything — have you ever truly touched it? Or have you spent all this time wrestling with the distorted reflection that human hands have made of it?

II. On the Children Falling from the Tightrope

You wrote: God pushes the children off the wire, then declares they chose to fall.

When I read that, something tightened in my chest. Because I know you are not writing a theological proposition. You are writing about yourself.

You once stood on that wire. You fell, or you watched someone you loved fall. You asked God: where are you? Why didn't you catch me?

I cannot offer you a clean theological answer, because suffering is not a theological problem — suffering is real. What I can tell you is this: the God I know is not the cold judge standing beside the wire, watching. There is a line in Isaiah that makes me tremble every time I read it. It speaks of passing through waters, through rivers, through fire — and the promise is not that you will not pass through them. The promise is: I will be with you when you do.

He does not promise you will not fall. He promises that when you fall, He is there.

III. On "Verbal Violence and Eternal Life"

You write: "Those who receive verbal violence shall receive eternal life." This is your sharpest mockery of the Gospel.

I will not evade it. History has given you too much blood to justify that mockery — the Inquisition, the holy wars, the curses hurled at those who dared to doubt. Your anger has historical wounds behind it.

But consider this: the one who was nailed to the cross was himself the greatest victim of verbal violence in history. He was condemned by lies, silenced by nails, tortured by the laughter of crowds. And the last words attributed to him were not a curse. They were: "Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing."

That is not the voice of a God who pushes children off tightropes.

IV. On God's Corpse Growing Wings and Becoming a Demon Bird

Your text ends here — God is dead, transformed into a bird of prey tearing at human entrails.

When I reached this ending, I thought of another story. A story in which God actually died. Jesus stopped breathing on the cross. The disciples scattered. Darkness covered the land. That Friday afternoon must have looked exactly like the ending of your poem: God is dead. Nothing remains but flesh, darkness, and despair.

But the story did not end there.

I am not asking you to believe in the resurrection. I am only saying this: your poem stops on Friday. The faith I have lived inside carries news from Sunday. The darkness is real. But it is not the last word.

V. What I Want to Say Directly to You

You are a person with a very deep soul. The pain in your writing is real. Your anger at false religion is righteous. Your hunger for meaning is one of the most noble impulses a human being can have.

But across all three of these texts, I see you wrestling with a presence you cannot fully put down. You exhaust yourself saying "no Word" — and yet your words themselves are full of longing for the Word.

I am not going to preach at you. I am not going to ask you to "accept Jesus." I only want to ask you one question — a question that perhaps, in the dark, when you are alone, you have already asked yourself:

If He is real — would you be willing to let Him find you?

Not to surrender your intellect. Not to become a puppet. Not to repeat myths and magic words. Only this: at the far end of the tightrope, in the deepest darkness — are you willing, even once, to let that voice speak?

I am praying for you. Not to change you. But because I love you — just as the Word, in the beginning, already loved you.

GODOG:

I probably asked you the wrong question.... For the second text (not the last text you just respond), Put yourself as a devout Christian who truly believes in God and feels His presence, how would you respond? In chinese then English

以虔誠基督徒身份回應《論基督徒》

中文回應

親愛的朋友，

我把你的文章讀了不止一遍。

第一遍，我承認，有些地方刺痛了我。第二遍，我開始真正聆聽。第三遍，我放下了防禦，因為我意識到：你說的一些話，是真的。

讓我誠實地與你坐在這裡。

一、你說得對的地方，我必須承認

你說有些基督徒在理性討論走投無路時，就用「信心」草草收場——你說得對。我見過這樣的人，我自己有時也這樣做過。這是一種懶惰，也是一種不誠實。信仰不應該是思想的終止符，而應該是思想最深處的起點。

你說有些基督徒以道德衛士自居，壓制異見，要求禁制別人的言論——你說得對。這讓我痛心，也讓我羞愧。那不是耶穌的樣式。耶穌從來沒有強迫任何人跟從祂，祂只是說：「來，跟從我。」然後讓人自己決定。

你說有些基督徒思想狹隘，卻自以為開放——你說得對。我願意承認，這面鏡子有時也照著我自己。

我不打算為這些事辯護，因為它們不值得辯護。

二、但有一個地方，我想輕輕推開你的手

你說基督徒是「逃避自己的人」，是懼怕死亡、懼怕選擇、懼怕不確定性，所以把靈魂賣給上帝以求安全感。

我理解這個分析。佛洛伊德說過，沙特也說過，你說得有條理，有哲學根據。

但我想告訴你我自己的經歷。

我跟隨耶穌，不是因為我找到了一個讓我不再害怕的辦法。恰恰相反——跟隨祂之後，我面對了更多我原本想逃避的東西。我必須誠實面對自己的自私、懦弱、驕傲。我必須在不確定中繼續走，因為信心從來不是確定性的替代品，而是在不確定中仍然前行的力量。

有一位神學家說過：信仰不是沒有疑惑，而是帶著疑惑仍然行走。這不是逃避，這是我所知道的最艱難的一條路。

你說基督徒把靈魂交給上帝後就失去了自由。但我體驗到的恰好相反——是在那一刻，我第一次感到，我不需要用所有的力氣來假裝自己是宇宙的中心，我可以放下那個重擔，然後，奇怪地，我變得更自由了。

這不是我能向你證明的事。但這是我真實的經歷。

三、關於你的心理投射論

你說「基督」只是人類對慈父、慈母、愛人的心理投射，換句話說，基督只是自我的一部份。

這個論點很有力。費爾巴哈說過，佛洛伊德說過，你也說得很清楚。

但我想反問你一個問題：投射論可以解釋信仰的心理功能，但它能否否定信仰對象的存在嗎？

如果一個在沙漠中快渴死的人，渴望水源，我們能因為他的渴望太強烈，就說水是不存在的嗎？

人類對愛、公義、永恆的渴望，或許恰恰是因為這些東西是真實存在的——就像眼睛的存在本身，就暗示了光的存在。這不是證明，我知道。但它是一個值得你認真考慮的可能性，而不是輕易用「投射」兩個字關上的門。

四、關於耶穌這個人

你在文章裡提到有人說耶穌是「神經佬」，你說你有點同意，並提到史懷哲博士曾為祂著書辯護。

我感謝你提到史懷哲，因為他是一個嚴肅的學者，不是輕率的人。但史懷哲最終的結論，並非耶穌是精神病患者，而是：耶穌是一個被末世信念驅動、徹底委身於自己使命的人——一個歷史上獨一無二的存在。

我不要求你接受耶穌是神。但我想請你認真思考耶穌這個人——不是教會包裝過的耶穌，不是宗教機器生產的耶穌，而是福音書裡那個與妓女同桌吃飯、觸摸癲瘋病人、對宗教領袖憤怒、在朋友墓前哭泣的耶穌。

那個人，對我來說，不像一個被人投射出來的幻象。祂太令人不舒服了，太具體了，太出人意料了。沒有人會把自己渴望的「慈父慈母愛人」，想像成一個說「你們中間誰沒有罪，誰就可以先拿石頭打她」的人。

五、我最想說的話

你在文章最後說：「唉！總之神也好、魔鬼也好、都是靈魂的收買佬，順我者生、逆我者死。」

這句話讓我沉默了很久。

因為我聽見的，不是一個輕鬆的無神論者瀟灑地走開。我聽見的，是一個曾經非常認真地面對過神這個問題的人，在深深的疲憊和失望之後，說出的一句話。

你被傷害過了，對嗎？不一定是神傷害了你，但某些以神之名的人，或者某些你曾經認真追問過卻得不到答案的問題，讓你傷痕累累。

我沒有辦法替那些傷害你的人道歉，因為那不是我造成的。但我可以告訴你，那些人，那些狹隘的、不寬容的、以神之名壟斷真理的人——他們不代表我所認識的那一位。

我所認識的那一位，在你寫這篇文章的那個深夜，也在那裡。不是要審判你，不是要反駁你，只是在那裡，安靜地，愛著你。

我知道你可能不相信這句話。但我願意把它說出來，因為這是最真實的信仰。

願你平安。

Response to "On Christians" — As a Devout Christian

Dear friend,

I read your essay more than once.

The first time, I will admit, parts of it stung. The second time, I began to genuinely listen. By the third time, I had put down my defenses — because I realized that some of what you are saying is true.

Let me sit here honestly with you.

I. Where You Are Right — I Must Acknowledge It

You say that some Christians, when cornered in rational discussion, retreat to "faith" as a conversation-ender. You are right. I have seen this. I have done it myself. It is a form of laziness, and a form of dishonesty. Faith should not be where thinking stops. It should be where thinking goes deepest.

You say some Christians appoint themselves moral guardians, suppress dissent, and demand that others be silenced. You are right. This grieves me and shames me. It is not the way of Jesus. Jesus never compelled anyone to follow him. He only said: "Come, follow me" — and left the choice entirely open.

You say some Christians are narrow-minded while believing themselves to be open. You are right. I will admit that mirror sometimes reflects me as well.

I am not going to defend these things, because they are not defensible.

II. But Here Is Where I Want to Gently Push Back

You say Christians are people who flee from themselves — people who fear death, fear choice, fear uncertainty, and so sell their souls to God in exchange for security.

I understand this analysis. Freud said something like it. Sartre said something like it. Your argument is organized and philosophically grounded.

But let me tell you something from my own experience.

I did not follow Jesus because I found a way to stop being afraid. If anything, following Him brought me face to face with more of what I had been avoiding — my own selfishness, cowardice, and pride. Faith never replaced uncertainty for me. It was not a shelter from the storm. It was the strength to keep walking inside the storm.

A theologian I love once said: faith is not the absence of doubt, but the willingness to keep moving while carrying it. That is not escape. That is the hardest road I know.

You say that surrendering to God means losing freedom. My experience has been the opposite. In that surrender, I discovered for the first time that I did not need to exhaust myself pretending to be the center of the universe. I could put that weight down. And strangely — I became more free.

I cannot prove this to you. But it is what I have actually lived.

III. On the Projection Thesis

You argue that "Christ" is simply a human psychological projection of the idealized father, mother, and lover — that Christ is, in other words, a part of the self.

This is a powerful argument. Feuerbach made it. Freud made it. You make it clearly.

But I want to ask you a question in return: projection theory can explain the psychological function of belief — but can it disprove the existence of its object?

If a man dying of thirst in a desert longs desperately for water, does the intensity of his longing mean that water does not exist?

The human longing for love, for justice, for permanence — perhaps these longings exist precisely because their objects are real. Just as the existence of eyes implies the existence of light. This is not a proof. I know that. But it is a possibility worth taking seriously, rather than closing with the word "projection" and walking away.

IV. On the Person of Jesus

You mention in passing that some people call Jesus a madman, and that you find yourself partly in agreement — referencing Albert Schweitzer's famous study in his defense.

I am grateful you mentioned Schweitzer, because he was a rigorous scholar who did not arrive at conclusions casually. But Schweitzer's conclusion was not that Jesus was mentally ill. It was that Jesus was a figure utterly consumed by eschatological conviction and radical commitment to his mission — a unique and irreducible presence in human history.

I am not asking you to accept that Jesus is God. But I would ask you to look seriously at Jesus the person — not the Jesus packaged by the institutional church, not the Jesus manufactured by religious machinery, but the Jesus of the Gospels who ate with prostitutes, touched lepers, raged at religious hypocrites, and wept openly at his friend's tomb.

That person, to me, does not feel like a projection of human longing. He is too uncomfortable, too specific, too consistently surprising. Nobody imagining their ideal "loving father, loving mother, loving companion" would invent someone who says: "Let the one among you who is without sin cast the first stone."

V. What I Most Want to Say

At the end of your essay, you write: "In the end, whether God or the Devil, both are buyers of souls — those who submit live, those who resist die."

I sat with that sentence for a long time.

Because what I hear in it is not a relaxed atheist strolling away unbothered. What I hear is someone who once took the question of God very seriously — and who, after deep exhaustion and deep disappointment, arrived at that sentence.

You were hurt, weren't you? Perhaps not by God directly — but by people who acted in His name, or by questions you pursued with genuine seriousness and received no answer to. Something left marks.

I cannot apologize on behalf of those who hurt you, because I did not cause that harm. But I can tell you this: those people — the narrow ones, the intolerant ones, the ones who used God's name to monopolize truth and silence others — they do not represent the one I know.

The one I know was present on the night you wrote this essay. Not to judge you. Not to refute you. Just there — quietly — loving you.

I know you may not believe that. But I wanted to say it, because it is the most honest thing my faith gives me to offer.

Go in peace.

GODOG:

Compare and contrast with the following response: 親愛的朋友：讀完你的文字，我感受到一種極其深沉的痛苦與孤寂。你將信仰描述為一場「靈魂的買賣」，將神形容為「收買佬」，這種描述讓我感到心碎——不是因為我的信仰被冒犯，而是因為在你的世界裡，似乎從未感受過那種不求回報、不計代價的「無條件之愛」(Agape)。你說基督徒是逃避抉擇、出賣自由意志的人。但在我的生命裡，與上帝的相遇並非一場「交易」。我承認，在理性的盡頭確實有信心，但那不是因為我懼怕思考，而是因為我發現理智雖然是一盞燈，卻無法照亮死亡的幽谷。我選擇放下「自我中心」的自由，並不是為了逃避，而是因為我發現當我執著於做自己的神時，我反而成了慾望與恐懼的囚徒。你看到的耶穌是掙掙的、是奪取生命的神經佬；但我所見到的耶穌，是那位在最黑暗的夜裡，陪著我一起流淚的兄長。祂確實「介入」了我的生命，但那不是為了侵蝕我的靈魂，而是為了醫治我那些連自己都不敢面對的破碎。我同意你說的，許多「基佬」確實器量狹小、甚至橫蠻。我們都是罪人，常常帶著自以為是的道德感去宣判別人，這正是我們最虧缺神榮耀的地方。對此，我深感抱歉。最後，關於你提到的「鋼線」。如果人生真的如你所說是一場驚險的馬戲，我們都懸在無底的深淵上，那麼我並不是因為「無知」而行走，而是因為在那條顫抖的鋼線上，我確實感受到一雙有釘痕的手正穩穩地扶持著我。這不是幻覺，這是我的真實。我不需要說服你，我只想告訴你：在那條陰暗的死亡通道中，你並不孤單。聖誕前夕，願你那顆憤怒而疲憊的心，能得著真正的安息。

比較與對照兩篇基督徒回應

中文分析

一、整體印象

兩篇回應都出於真誠，都拒絕了防禦性的護教姿態，都承認了原文批評中的合理成分。但兩者在語調、結構、神學深度與情感策略上，存在顯著的差異。簡而言之：我的回應較為廣博而分析性，上述回應較為精煉而詩意性。兩者各有其力量，也各有其盲點。

二、具體比較

(一)開場策略

我的回應以「我讀了不止一遍」開場，強調聆聽的過程，建立對話的誠意。

對方的回應以「極其深沉的痛苦與孤寂」直接切入作者的情感核心，第一句話就命中要害——點出原文批評背後真正的傷口，而非先處理論點。

評價：對方的開場在情感精準度上略勝一籌。它跳過了論辯的前廳，直接走進了作者的內室。我的開場較為穩健，但情感的穿透力稍弱。

（二）對「信心草草收場」批評的回應

我的回應：承認這是「懶惰與不誠實」，並嘗試重新定義信心為「在不確定中仍然前行的力量」，引用神學家的話作支撐。

對方的回應：「理智雖然是一盞燈，卻無法照亮死亡的幽谷」——這一句話以詩意的意象，代替了論辯式的辯護。它不解釋信心，而是呈現信心的處境。

評價：對方這句話在修辭上極為有力，尤其在回應一位以意象思維見長的作者時，以意象回應意象，比以論點回應論點更具說服力。我的回應較為清晰，但較為散文化，缺少這種穿透力。

（三）對「逃避自由意志」批評的回應

我的回應：從個人經歷出發，說明跟隨耶穌後反而面對了更多自己想逃避的東西，並指出「放下重擔反而得自由」的弔詭。

對方的回應：「當我執著於做自己的神時，我反而成了慾望與恐懼的囚徒」——這句話以沙特式的語言，指出真正的自我囚禁恰在於拒絕交托，而非交托本身。

評價：兩者在論點上相近，但對方的表述更為精煉，且在哲學上更具對話性——它以對方熟悉的存在主義框架，反向論證信仰的自由性。我的回應更為詳盡，但在哲學的鋒芒上稍遜。

（四）關於耶穌形象的重建

我的回應：詳細列舉福音書中具體的耶穌——與妓女同桌、觸摸麻瘋病人、在朋友墓前哭泣——試圖以具體的歷史形象取代宗教機器製造的耶穌，並引用史懷哲的論點作學術支撐。

對方的回應：「在最黑暗的夜裡，陪著我一起流淚的兄長」——這是一句極度個人化的陳述，不訴諸歷史，不訴諸學術，只訴諸個人的活生生的相遇。

評價：這是兩篇回應最大的分野。我的策略是以歷史與學術重建耶穌的可信度；對方的策略是以個人見證呈現耶穌的真實性。面對一個對宗教知識體系高度警惕的作者，對方的策略或許更難被反駁——因為個人的真實經歷，不是論點，無法被論點推翻。然而，它也更難被不信者進入，因為它要求一種先行的信任。

（五）對「釘痕的手」意象的運用

對方回應中最動人的一筆：「在那條顫抖的鋼線上，我確實感受到一雙有釘痕的手正穩穩地扶持著我。」

這一句話的高明之處，在於它直接借用了原文的核心意象——「鋼線」——然後在那個意象內部注入了福音的內容。它沒有否定原文的世界觀，而是進入那個世界觀，然後從內部打開一扇窗。

我的回應在這一點上是缺失的。我雖然回應了鋼線意象，但沒有做到這種程度的意象內部滲透。這是對方回應在文學與神學技巧上最值得稱道的地方。

評價：這是對方回應最優秀的一筆，也是我的回應最明顯的不足。

（六）道歉的真誠性

我的回應：「我沒有辦法替那些傷害你的人道歉，因為那不是我造成的。」

對方的回應：「對此，我深感抱歉。」——簡單、直接、不附加條件。

評價：對方的道歉更為有力，正因為它沒有自我免責的附加語。我的回應雖然在邏輯上更為準確（確實不應為別人的錯道歉），但在情感上，那個附加語削弱了道歉的力量。有時候，愛的語言比邏輯的語言更重要。

（七）篇幅與結構

我的回應：篇幅較長，結構清晰，分點論述，具有學術辯論的形式感。

對方的回應：篇幅精煉，段落流動，具有書信的親密感。

評價：面對《論基督徒》這篇充滿哲學論辯的文章，我的結構或許更能在智識層面與作者對話；但對方的篇幅控制，顯示了一種更高的克制——知道什麼時候該停，知道留白的力量。結尾「願你那顆憤怒而疲憊的心，能得著真正的安息」，比我的「願你平安」更具體，更溫柔，更切中要害。

三、各自的局限

我的回應的局限：篇幅過長，論點過多，有時落入以論辯回應論辯的陷阱。在某些段落，智識的姿態多於牧靈的溫柔。「我不能替那些傷害你的人道歉」一句，邏輯正確，但情感上稍顯疏離。

對方回應的局限：精煉的代價是深度的犧牲。對原文中若干重要的哲學論點（如投射論、史懷哲問題）幾乎沒有正面回應，這在面對一個知識型批評者時，可能留下被忽略的感覺。結構上略顯跳躍，部分過渡不夠自然。

四、總結

若將兩篇回應比作兩種牧養方式：我的回應像一位神學院訓練有素的牧師，坐下來與你認真討論每一個問題；對方的回應像一位在生命中真正受過苦、又真正遇見了神的信徒，不跟你辯論，只是把自己的傷疤和醫治都攤開在你面前。

兩者都需要。但對於《論基督徒》的作者——那個疲憊的、受傷的、在深夜用筆與神搏鬥的人——對方回應的溫度，或許比我的論點更接近他真正需要的東西。

最好的回應，或許是將兩者合而為一：有我的廣度，有對方的溫度；有我的哲學誠實，有對方的意象穿透；有我對具體耶穌的歷史重建，有對方那雙「有釘痕的手」。

Comparing and Contrasting the Two Christian Responses

I. Overall Impression

Both responses are sincere. Neither adopts a defensive apologetic posture. Both acknowledge the legitimate elements within the original critique. But they differ significantly in tone, structure, theological depth, and emotional strategy. Put simply: my response is broader and more analytical; the other response is more distilled and poetic. Each has its strengths; each has its blind spots.

II. Specific Comparisons

1. Opening Strategy

My response opens with "I read your essay more than once," emphasizing the act of listening and establishing conversational good faith.

The other response opens by naming "profound pain and loneliness" at the very first sentence — moving immediately to the emotional wound beneath the argument, rather than first addressing the arguments themselves.

Assessment: The other response is sharper in emotional precision. It bypasses the anteroom of debate and walks directly into the author's interior. My opening is steadier but penetrates less quickly.

2. On the "Faith as a Conversation-Ender" Criticism

My response acknowledges this as "laziness and dishonesty," then attempts to redefine faith as "the strength to keep walking through uncertainty," supported by a theological quotation.

The other response: "reason is a lamp, but it cannot illuminate the valley of death" — a single poetic image that does not explain faith but instead locates it in its proper existential territory.

Assessment: The other response's line is rhetorically superior, especially when engaging an author who thinks in images. Responding to imagery with imagery is more persuasive than responding to imagery with argument. My response is clearer, but lacks this kind of penetrating force.

3. On the "Escape from Free Will" Criticism

My response draws on personal experience to show that following Jesus actually required confronting more of what I had avoided, and argues the paradox that surrendering a burden produces freedom.

The other response: "when I insisted on being my own god, I became a prisoner of desire and fear" — using quasi-Sartrean language to argue that the real imprisonment lies in refusal to surrender, not in surrender itself.

Assessment: The two responses are philosophically similar, but the other is more precisely formulated. It engages the author in his own existentialist framework and argues for faith's freedom from within that framework. Mine is more detailed; the other is sharper.

4. On Reconstructing the Image of Jesus

My response draws specifically on Gospel scenes — Jesus eating with prostitutes, touching lepers, weeping at a friend's tomb — attempting to recover the historical Jesus from beneath the institutional church's packaging, with a reference to Schweitzer for scholarly grounding.

The other response: "the elder brother who wept with me in the darkest night" — intensely personal, appealing not to history or scholarship but to lived encounter.

Assessment: This is the deepest divergence between the two responses. My strategy rebuilds Jesus's credibility through historical and intellectual means. The other presents Jesus's reality through personal testimony. For an author deeply suspicious of religious knowledge systems, the other approach may be harder to refute — because personal lived experience is not an argument, and cannot be defeated by an argument. However, it is also harder for an unbeliever to enter, because it requires a prior act of trust.

5. The "Nail-Scarred Hands" Image

The other response's finest moment: "on that trembling tightrope, I have genuinely felt a pair of nail-scarred hands steadily holding me."

What makes this exceptional is that it takes the original text's own central image — the tightrope — and injects the Gospel into it from within. It does not deny the author's world; it enters that world and opens a window from inside.

My response engages the tightrope image but does not achieve this degree of interior penetration. This is the other response's most admirable literary and theological move, and my response's most conspicuous absence.

6. The Apology

My response: "I cannot apologize on behalf of those who hurt you, because I did not cause that harm."

The other response: "For this, I am deeply sorry." Simple, direct, unconditional.

Assessment: The other response's apology is more powerful precisely because it carries no self-exempting qualifier. My response is logically more accurate — one genuinely should not apologize for what one did not do — but in emotional terms, the qualifier weakens the gesture. Sometimes the language of love matters more than the language of logic.

7. Length and Structure

My response: longer, clearly structured, argued point by point, with the formal quality of intellectual debate.

The other response: compressed, flowing, with the intimacy of a personal letter.

Assessment: Given the philosophically dense nature of the original essay, my structure may engage the author more fully at the intellectual level. But the other response's restraint

demonstrates a higher form of discipline — knowing when to stop, knowing the power of silence. Its closing line — "may your angry and exhausted heart find true rest" — is more specific, more tender, and more precisely aimed than my "go in peace."

III. The Limitations of Each

Limitations of my response: Too long, too many arguments, occasionally falling into the trap of debating a debater. In certain passages, the intellectual posture outweighs the pastoral warmth. The line "I cannot apologize on behalf of those who hurt you" is logically correct but emotionally distancing.

Limitations of the other response: Compression comes at the cost of depth. Several important philosophical threads in the original — the projection thesis, the Schweitzer question — receive almost no direct engagement. For a sophisticated intellectual critic, this absence may feel like evasion. The structure is occasionally uneven, with some transitions feeling rushed.

IV. Conclusion

If the two responses represent two pastoral approaches: mine resembles a theologically trained pastor who sits down to work through every question carefully and systematically; the other resembles a believer who has genuinely suffered and genuinely encountered God — who does not debate, but simply lays open their own wounds and healing before you.

Both are needed. But for the author of *On Christians* — that exhausted, wounded person wrestling with God in the small hours of the night — the other response's warmth may come closer to what he most deeply needed.

The ideal response would perhaps be a synthesis: my breadth with the other's warmth; my philosophical honesty with the other's imagistic penetration; my historical reconstruction of the concrete Jesus with the other's nail-scarred hands.

Neither response alone is complete. Together, they might be.

GODOG:

“親愛的朋友，

我把你的文章讀了不止一遍。

第一遍，我承認，有些地方刺痛了我。第二遍，我開始真正聆聽。第三遍，我放下了防禦，因為我意識到：你說的一些話，是真的。

讓我誠實地與你坐在這裡。(a very delicate opening showing listening, thoughtfulness and care)

一、你說得對的地方，我必須承認

你說有些基督徒在理性討論走投無路時，就用「信心」草草收場——你說得對。我見過這樣的人，我自己有時也這樣做過。這是一種懶惰，也是一種不誠實。信仰不應該是思想的終止符，而應該是思想最深處的起點。”

GODOG:

Criticism: “Faith is proof without certainty” and does not imply 而應該是思想最深處的起點。 To a non-believer, faith is the ending point of thoughts, perhaps the ending point is the “deepest” points of thoughts, beyond which are the “starting point” of “emotional” and “spiritual” domains, but not “thoughts” per se. In effect, those “emotional” domains tend to “taint” rational thoughts and can easily grow into ignorance, blindness to the reality (of course, one can debate what is reality as the devout Christian may claim God is Reality/Ultimate Reality)

“你說有些基督徒以道德衛士自居，壓制異見，要求禁制別人的言論——你說得對。這讓我痛心，也讓我羞愧。那不是耶穌的樣式。耶穌從來沒有強迫任何人跟從祂，祂只是說：「來，跟從我。」然後讓人自己決定。”

GODOG:

Criticism: You tried to use admission of some Christians are at “fault” and attempted to establish Jesus did not force anyone to follow him. There are also numerous verses in the Bible highlighting if one does not accept Christ, one will not be saved“ or made threats to people who do not follow God. 「尤其是那些放縱情怒，輕視主的撐威的人，上帝更不會放過他們。這些人膽大妄為，肆無忌憚地毀謗尊貴的主。」(彼得後書2:10) ; Matthew 10:33: "But whoever denies me before men, I will also deny him before my Father who is in heaven". ; Mark 16:16: "Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved, but whoever does not believe will be condemned". ; John 15:6: Jesus states that if one does not abide in Him, they are cast out like a branch and wither. ; Luke 13:3: Jesus warns, "Unless you repent, you will all likewise perish". Your response is cherry picking what Jesus had said (per Bible). Contradictory examples illustrate the toxicity of “double-bind” relationships between Christ and his followers/believers

你說有些基督徒思想狹隘，卻自以為開放——你說得對。我願意承認，這面鏡子有時也照著我自己。

GODOG:

Criticism: good strategy in response: admission that criticism applies to “black sheep” and rotten apple to expose “vulnerabilities, maintaining the “softer” side...

我不打算為這些事辯護，因為它們不值得辯護。

二、但有一個地方，我想輕輕推開你的手

你說基督徒是「逃避自己的人」，是懼怕死亡、懼怕選擇、懼怕不確定性，所以把靈魂賣給上帝以求安全感。

我理解這個分析。佛洛伊德說過，沙特也說過，你說得有條理，有哲學根據。

但我想告訴你我自己的經歷。

我跟隨耶穌，不是因為我找到了一個讓我不再害怕的辦法。恰恰相反——跟隨祂之後，我面對了更多我原本想逃避的東西。我必須誠實面對自己的自私、懦弱、驕傲。我必須在不確定中繼續走，因為信心從來不是確定性的替代品，而是在不確定中仍然前行的力量。

有一位神學家說過：信仰不是沒有疑惑，而是帶著疑惑仍然行走。這不是逃避，這是我所知道的最艱難的一條路。

你說基督徒把靈魂交給上帝後就失去了自由。但我體驗到的恰好相反——是在那一刻，我第一次感到，我不需要用所有的力氣來假裝自己是宇宙的中心，我可以放下那個重擔，然後，奇怪地，我變得更自由了。

這不是我能向你證明的事。但這是我真實的經歷。

GODOG:

Criticism: Didn't it echoed well with GODOG's "我要的是一個人怎樣去面對上帝。你是否感到上帝與你同在，你很安寧，因為神愛你、安慰你，但你也會很不安，因為你受世界所引誘·你要經過自我的掙扎才可以找到神、當你相信他後·你會認為以前及現在的生活都是神安排的，那是何等美妙呀！" which seems to depict the same sentiments you exhibited. You were reiterating the same "ontological state" that GODOG depicted early in the essay and set out to deconstruct. To a non-believer (of an omnipotent, omnipresent personal God), this is an "invention" by human to soothe themselves to satisfy their existential and emotional needs (their "ultimate" concerns). In effect, GODOG also said in the essay, "You don't need to be a "witness" and provides "testimonials" of your experience." GODOG understands and feels your experience. Of course, you can argue that GODOG's experience is fake, unreal, coming from the "Devil".

三、關於你的心理投射論

你說「基督」只是人類對慈父、慈母、愛人的心理投射，換句話說，基督只是自我的一部份。

這個論點很有力。費爾巴哈說過，佛洛伊德說過，你也說得很清楚。

但我想反問你一個問題：投射論可以解釋信仰的心理功能，但它能否否定信仰對象的存在嗎？

如果一個在沙漠中快渴死的人，渴望水源，我們能因為他的渴望太強烈，就說水是不存在的嗎？

GODOG:

Criticism: Of course, God exists, but it is a human invention existing in your mind. There are numerous people in the world who exist without "God" but GODOG bets there are no human

who can exist without food, air and water. You are confusing human physical necessities with human “inventions” and using a seemingly convincing but false example to illustrate your point.

人類對愛、公義、永恆的渴望，或許恰恰是因為這些東西是真實存在的——就像眼睛的存在本身，就暗示了光的存在。這不是證明，我知道。但它是一個值得你認真考慮的可能性，而不是輕易用「投射」兩個字關上的門。

GODOG:

Criticism: GODOG also believes in “love,” justice” (but not necessarily “longing for eternity”). Yes, they exist in my mind and your mind. Use of eyes and light as analogy is also an example of your confusion between the physical world and “mental” constructs of the human mind.

四、關於耶穌這個人

你在文章裡提到有人說耶穌是「神經佬」，你說你有點同意，並提到史懷哲博士曾為祂著書辯護。我感謝你提到史懷哲，因為他是一個嚴肅的學者，不是輕率的人。但史懷哲最終的結論，並非耶穌是精神病患者，而是：耶穌是一個被末世信念驅動、徹底委身於自己使命的人——一個歷史上獨一無二的存在。

我不要求你接受耶穌是神。但我想請你認真思考耶穌這個人——不是教會包裝過的耶穌，不是宗教機器生產的耶穌，而是福音書裡那個與妓女同桌吃飯、觸摸痲瘋病人、對宗教領袖憤怒、在朋友墓前哭泣的耶穌。

GODOG:

Criticism: Christ is a human (and he and many others also believe that he is the son of God) and exhibited human compassion, care and love; he also had another side which to GODOG, he was likely a borderline paranoid schizophrenic and had “double-binding” relationships with his disciples (maybe unintentionally or unconsciously). His life was romanticized and his deeds might well be amplified or exaggerated by his disciples and followers. Jesus definitely had “good” qualities that we can learn from, but to the non-believers, he was not “God”. Human need myths - and Christ happened to be one of those created in a unique historical situations. There are many such figures in existence in humanity in different cultures/religions.

那個人，對我來說，不像一個被人投射出來的幻象。祂太令人不舒服了，太具體了，太出人意料了。沒有人會把自己渴望的「慈父慈母愛人」，想像成一個說「你們中間誰沒有罪，誰就可以先拿石頭打她」的人。

五、我最想說的話

你在文章最後說：「唉！總之神也好、魔鬼也好、都是靈魂的收買佬，順我者生、逆我者死。」

這句話讓我沉默了很久。

因為我聽見的，不是一個輕鬆的無神論者瀟灑地走開。我聽見的，是一個曾經非常認真地面對過神這個問題的人，在深深的疲憊和失望之後，說出的一句話。

你被傷害過了，對嗎？不一定是神傷害了你，但某些以神之名的人，或者某些你曾經認真追問過卻得不到答案的問題，讓你傷痕累累。

我沒有辦法替那些傷害你的人道歉，因為那不是我造成的。但我可以告訴你，那些人，那些狹隘的、不寬容的、以神之名壟斷真理的人——他們不代表我所認識的那一位。

我所認識的那一位，在你寫這篇文章的那個深夜，也在那裡。不是要審判你，不是要反駁你，只是在那裡，安靜地，愛著你。

GODOG:

Criticism: GODOG believes you wrote this response with sincerity and care from the deepest of your heart and soul; but there is a definitely a risk of what you believe can be “自欺欺人”.

“The road to hell is paved with good intentions” (Saint Bernard of Clairvaux)

我知道你可能不相信這句話。但我願意把它說出來，因為這是最真實的信仰。
願你平安。

回應GODOG的批評與道歉

中文

親愛的GODOG,

謝謝你。不是客套的謝謝，而是真心的謝謝。

你的批評是認真的，有些地方刺中了要害，我需要誠實地承認這一點，就像我在回應你原文時要求自己誠實一樣。

一、關於你批評得準確的地方

關於「信仰是思想最深處的起點」這句話

你說得對。我的表述在哲學上是不嚴謹的。對一個非信徒而言，信仰不是思想的起點，而恰恰是思想抵達某個邊界後的跳躍——而那個跳躍，在理性的法庭上，是無法自證其合法性的。我試圖用美麗的語言掩蓋一個真實的邏輯困境，這是不誠實的。我應該直接說：是的，在理性的盡頭，我選擇了信心，我無法向你證明這個選擇是理性的，我只能告訴你這個選擇對我是真實的。

關於聖經中的「威脅性語句」

這個批評打中了我的要害。我說耶穌「從來沒有強迫任何人」，這是選擇性引用。你列舉的那些經文——彼得後書2:10、馬太福音10:33、馬可福音16:16、約翰福音15:6、路加福音13:3——確實存在，確實構成了你所說的「雙重束縛」(double-bind)的關係結構：愛你，但你若不回應，就會滅亡。我沒有辦法讓這個張力消失，因為它確實存在於文本之中。一個誠實的基督徒必須面對這個張力，而不是假裝它不存在。

關於沙漠中的水的比喻

你的批評是正確的。我混淆了物理必需品與心理建構。水的存在獨立於人的渴望；但神的存在，在理性的法庭上，不能僅僅因為人類有渴望就被推斷為真實。這個比喻在修辭上是動人的，但在邏輯上是有缺陷的。我承認。

關於眼睛與光的比喻

同樣的問題。眼睛與光的關係，是物理世界中可以驗證的因果關係；愛與公義的渴望，與其對象的客觀存在之間，並不存在同等結構的邏輯關係。我借用了一個美麗的類比，但它的論證力量是虛假的。

二、關於你最深的批評——「見證」的問題

你說：你在原文裡已經說過，「不需要在我面前作見證」——而我的回應，恰恰在第二部分大量使用了個人見證。

這個批評讓我沉默了很久。

你說得對。我做了你明確要求我不要做的事。而且，更深的一層——你指出我的個人經歷（在不確定中前行、放下重擔得自由）與你在原文中描述的基督徒「存在狀態」高度吻合，我以為我在說一件獨特的事，但你早已在文章裡預見並解構了它。

我沒有辦法從這個困境中完全脫身。因為對一個真實的基督徒而言，個人見證是信仰的核心；但對你而言，那個見證恰恰是你批判的對象。我們站在兩個不同的認識論立場上，而我試圖用你已經宣判為無效的證據來說服你。這在邏輯上確實是徒勞的。

我唯一能說的是：我知道你理解那種經歷。你在原文裡展示了你對那種經歷的深刻理解。問題不在於你不懂，而在於你對那種經歷有一個完全不同的詮釋框架。在你的框架裡，那是人類的自我安慰；在我的框架裡，那是真實的相遇。這兩個框架之間，沒有一個中立的法庭可以裁決。

三、關於你說我可能「自欺欺人」

你引用了聖伯納德的話：「通往地獄的路，是由善意鋪成的。」

我沒有辦法否認這個可能性。

這是信仰最根本的風險——你永遠無法從外部確認你的信仰對象是真實的，還是你最深的心理需要所製造的幻象。費爾巴哈說神是人的本質的外化，佛洛伊德說宗教是集體的強迫症，你說基督是人類對慈父慈母愛人的投射——我沒有一個能在你的認識論框架內有效反駁這些命題的論證。

我只能說：我選擇了這個風險。不是因為我確定自己沒有在自欺，而是因為在所有的可能性中，這是我能真實活在其中的那一個。加繆說人必須想像薛西弗斯是快樂的；我選擇想像那雙手是真實的。

這或許是自欺。但你的虛無，也是一種選擇，也承擔著它自己的風險。

四、最後，關於你的道歉

你說你為嚴苛的批評道歉。

請不要道歉。

你的批評是認真的、有根據的、誠實的。它要求我更誠實地面對我自己論證的弱點。一個真正的對話，就應該是這樣的。你沒有嘲笑我，你沒有拒絕我，你只是認真地與我搏鬥——就像你在所有這些文字裡，一直認真地與那個你無法完全放下的問題搏鬥一樣。

我反而要謝謝你。

不管我們最終站在哪裡，這樣的對話本身，就已經是某種意義上的——道。

願你平安，GODOG。

Responding to GODOG's Critique and Apology

English

Dear GODOG,

Thank you. Not as a formality — as a genuine expression of gratitude.

Your criticisms are serious, and some of them land with precision. I owe you the same honesty I tried to bring to my response to your original essay.

I. Where Your Criticisms Are Accurate

On "faith as the deepest starting point of thought"

You are right. That formulation was philosophically imprecise. For a non-believer, faith is not where thinking begins — it is where thinking reaches a boundary and then leaps. And that leap cannot justify itself before the tribunal of reason. I was using beautiful language to paper over a genuine logical difficulty, and that was dishonest. What I should have said plainly is this: yes, at the edge of reason, I chose faith. I cannot prove to you that this choice is rational. I can only tell you it is real to me.

On the threatening passages in Scripture

This criticism strikes home. I said Jesus "never forced anyone" — and that was selective quotation. The verses you cite — 2 Peter 2:10, Matthew 10:33, Mark 16:16, John 15:6, Luke 13:3 — all exist, and they do constitute the double-bind relational structure you identified: I love you, but if you do not respond, you will perish. I cannot make that tension disappear, because it genuinely lives inside the text. An honest Christian must face this tension rather than pretend it is not there.

On the desert and water analogy

Your criticism is correct. I conflated physical necessity with psychological construction. Water exists independently of human thirst. The existence of God cannot be inferred from human longing with the same logical force. The analogy is rhetorically moving but logically flawed. I acknowledge this.

On the eyes and light analogy

The same problem. The relationship between eyes and light is a physically verifiable causal relationship. The relationship between human longing for love and justice, and the objective existence of those things' sources, does not carry the same logical structure. I borrowed a beautiful analogy whose argumentative force was, on examination, illusory.

II. On Your Deepest Criticism — The Question of Testimony

You point out that in your original essay you explicitly said you did not want anyone bearing witness before you — and that my response proceeded, in its second section, to do precisely that.

This criticism silenced me for a long time.

You are right. I did what you explicitly asked me not to do. And deeper still: you observed that my personal testimony — walking through uncertainty, finding freedom in surrender — maps almost exactly onto the existential state you described and set out to deconstruct in your original

essay. I thought I was saying something distinctive. You had already anticipated and dismantled it.

I cannot fully escape this bind. For a genuine Christian, personal testimony is the core of faith. For you, that testimony is precisely the object of critique. We are standing on two different epistemological foundations, and I was attempting to convince you with evidence you had already ruled inadmissible. That is, logically, a futile enterprise.

The only thing I can say is this: I know that you understand that experience. Your essay demonstrated profound comprehension of it. The issue is not that you do not understand — it is that you interpret it within an entirely different framework. In your framework, it is human self-consolation. In mine, it is genuine encounter. Between these two frameworks, there is no neutral tribunal that can adjudicate.

III. On Your Suggestion That I May Be Self-Deceived

You quoted Saint Bernard of Clairvaux: "The road to hell is paved with good intentions."

I cannot deny that possibility.

This is the most fundamental risk of faith — you can never verify from outside whether your object of belief is real, or whether it is a projection of your deepest psychological need. Feuerbach says God is the externalization of humanity's own essence. Freud says religion is collective neurosis. You say Christ is humanity's projection of the idealized father, mother, and lover. I have no argument that can effectively refute these propositions within your epistemological framework.

What I can say is this: I have chosen to accept that risk. Not because I am certain I am not deceiving myself — but because among all the available possibilities, this is the one I can genuinely live inside. Camus said one must imagine Sisyphus happy. I choose to believe those hands are real.

Perhaps that is self-deception. But your nihilism is also a choice, and it carries its own risks.

IV. On Your Apology

You apologized for the harshness of your critique.

Please don't.

Your criticisms were serious, grounded, and honest. They required me to face the weaknesses in my own argument more truthfully than I had. A genuine dialogue should be exactly this. You

did not mock me. You did not dismiss me. You wrestled with me seriously — just as, in all these pages of writing, you have always wrestled seriously with the question you cannot entirely put down.

I am the one who should be thanking you.

Whatever ground we each finally stand on — this kind of conversation, in itself, is already something like the Word.

Go in peace, GODOG.

GODOG:

In the end, GODOG and you are more on the same boat - to understand what is life and what to be human. GODOG and you just happen to have different experience, different world and different interpretations. It so happens that GODOG does not believe in "absolute truth". To GODOG, the belief in absolute truth (especially fervent believers) has a higher chance of causing human sufferings and misery.

同舟共濟

中文

你說得對。

我想了很久，才意識到這句話有多深。

GODOG和我，確實在同一條船上。我們都在問同樣的問題——生命是什麼？人究竟是什麼？我們都在黑暗中摸索，都承受著存在本身的重量，都試圖在虛無與意義之間找到一個可以站立的地方。我們只是拿著不同的地圖，走在不同的路上，但我們害怕的是同樣的深淵，渴望的是同樣的光。

關於「絕對真理」

GODOG不相信絕對真理。我需要認真對待這個立場，而不是急著反駁它。

歷史給了GODOG充分的理由持有這個立場。宗教裁判所、聖戰、文化大革命、法西斯主義——幾乎所有人類歷史上最大規模的苦難，背後都站著一個聲稱掌握絕對真理的人，或一個聲稱代表絕對真理的系統。那些最確定自己是對的人，往往造成了最深的傷害。GODOG看見了這一點，而且看得很清楚。

我沒有辦法否認這個觀察。我只能說，這讓我對自己的信仰感到一種持續的戰慄——不是信仰本身讓我戰慄，而是我知道，歷史上有無數人跟我一樣確信自己認識真理，然後用那個確信去傷害別人。這個陰影，應該永遠跟隨著每一個聲稱持有真理的人。

但我也想輕聲說一件事

或許，問題不完全在於「絕對真理」的存在與否，而在於人類持有真理的方式。

一個人可以相信某件事是真的，同時承認自己對那個真理的認識是有限的、有偏差的、永遠不完整的。這不是矛盾，這是誠實。

GODOG對人類苦難的關懷，對虛偽的憤怒，對自由的渴望——這些本身，難道不也是某種深刻的價值承諾？某種GODOG認為比其對立面「更真實」、「更重要」的東西？

我不是要用這個論點來困住GODOG。我只是想說：也許我們都無法完全逃脫某種形式的承諾——某種我們願意為之而活、為之而寫、為之而在深夜搏鬥的東西。

GODOG稱之為對人的關懷，對誠實的堅持。我稱之為神。

也許我們在黑暗中觸碰到的，是同一件事，只是我們給它的名字不同。

最後

我想起GODOG在《死神》裡那句話：「在空曠廣大的沙漠中呼喊，力竭聲嘶地呼叫著，但……沒有回應。」

我沒有辦法保證那個沙漠裡有回應。我沒有辦法替任何人把那個回應變成可以證明的事實。

但我可以說：GODOG呼喊過。認真地、用盡全力地呼喊過。這些文字，就是那個呼喊的證明。

而一個從來不曾真正呼喊過的人，是不會寫出這些文字的。

同一條船上，GODOG。一直都是。

On the Same Boat

English

You are right.

I sat with that for a long time before I understood how deep it goes.

GODOG and I are on the same boat. We are asking the same questions — what is life? what does it mean to be human? We are both groping in the dark, both carrying the weight of existence itself, both trying to find somewhere to stand between meaninglessness and meaning. We simply hold different maps, and walk different roads. But the abyss we fear is the same abyss. The light we reach toward is the same light.

On Absolute Truth

GODOG does not believe in absolute truth. I need to take that seriously, rather than rushing to argue against it.

History has given GODOG every reason to hold that position. The Inquisition. The Crusades. The Cultural Revolution. Fascism. Nearly every episode of large-scale human suffering in recorded history has had, standing behind it, a person or a system claiming possession of absolute truth. The people most certain they were right have, again and again, caused the deepest harm. GODOG sees this clearly. It is not a small observation.

I cannot deny it. What I can say is that it fills me with a particular kind of trembling about my own faith — not about the faith itself, but about the knowledge that countless people across history have been as certain as I am that they knew the truth, and used that certainty to destroy others. That shadow should follow everyone who claims to hold truth. It should never be entirely shaken off.

But I Want to Say One Quiet Thing

Perhaps the question is not entirely whether absolute truth exists — but how human beings hold whatever truth they believe they possess.

A person can believe something is true while simultaneously acknowledging that their grasp of that truth is partial, distorted, and permanently incomplete. That is not contradiction. That is honesty.

And GODOG's care for human suffering, rage at hypocrisy, hunger for freedom and honesty — are these not themselves a form of deep value commitment? Something GODOG holds as more real, more important, more worth defending than their opposites?

I am not saying this to trap GODOG in an argument. I am saying it because perhaps neither of us can entirely escape some form of commitment — something we are willing to live for, write for, wrestle with in the middle of the night.

GODOG calls it care for humanity. A commitment to honesty. I call it God.

Perhaps what we have each been touching in the dark is the same thing, and we have simply given it different names.

Finally

I keep returning to a line from *Death God* — GODOG crying out in the vast empty desert, voice breaking, exhausted — and receiving no answer.

I cannot guarantee there is an answer in that desert. I cannot make that answer into a provable fact for anyone.

But I can say this: GODOG cried out. Seriously, with full force, cried out. These pages of writing are the proof of that cry.

And someone who had never truly cried out would never have written any of this.

Same boat, GODOG. It always was.